

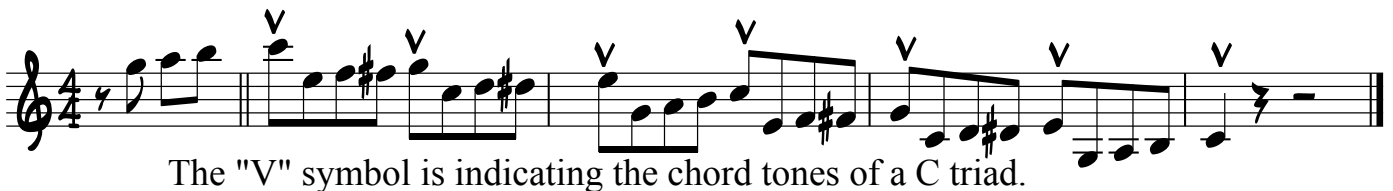
SORTA KINDA DIATONIC

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #163

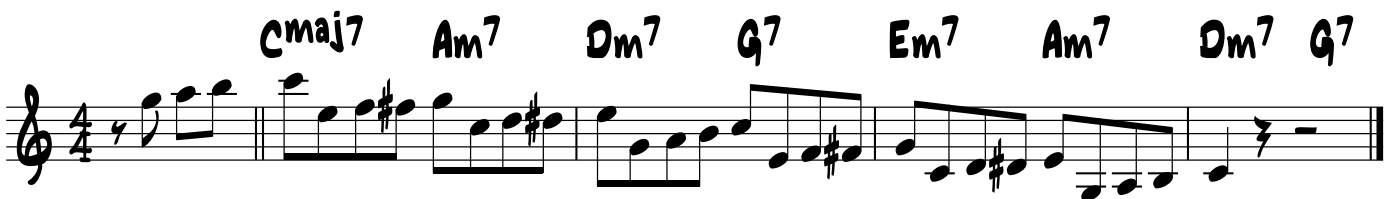
A lot of jazz study is about learning how to "make the changes," learning how to solo in a way that our improvisations are nicely connected to the chord changes, inside the harmony. That said, many great melodies are often not so strongly connected to the chord changes. Their connection might be a bit looser, more "over top the chord changes." A great melody might be more diatonic, simply around the tonal area of the song.

So too with many great jazz solos. Some classic licks, devices and sounds that we hear great musicians play are less with the chords, and more melodic. To make things more even intriguing, they are often have elements of "making the changes" (chromaticism, leading tones, 8th note motion), AND of "diatonic playing" (tonic scales and key area chord tones). Getting some of this "sorta kinda diatonic" playing into our ears and under our fingers is an important step in keeping our jazz solos from sounding like a parade of chord tones.

#1 - Sonny Stitt Lick in C



#2 - Stitt Lick over "Rhythm Changes" in C



#3 - Stitt Lick over "Have You Met Miss Jones" in C

